



BEST MID-SIZED
BANK
**BANK OF
MAHARASHTRA**

HOLDING STEADY

Bank of Maharashtra's mantra of ensuring profitability without compromising credit quality has helped it stay ahead of the pack

BY AMIT MUDGILL

Nidhu Saxena, MD & CEO,
Bank of Maharashtra

WITH GROSS NON-PER-
FORMING ASSETS (NPAs)
at decadal lows and
capital adequacy near

record highs, a bank's success hinges on its ability to sustain earnings, maintain credit discipline and leverage technology for cost efficiency, particularly in an easing rate cycle. These factors determine whether a lender can absorb margin pressure while delivering steady growth.

Bank of Maharashtra (BoM) ticks most of these boxes. As a result, it has been picked as the Best Mid-Sized Bank in the BT-KPMG Best Banks and NBFCs Survey.

Growth with profitability, without compromising on quality, remains BoM's mantra, says MD and CEO Nidhu Saxena. He tells *BT* that the lender maintained its focus on low-cost deposits, while paring a large portion of high-cost bulk deposits and exploring alternative funding sources to support profitable growth.

Saxena says customer centricity remained at the core of product development initiatives. Digital handholding solutions such as the Zen Lyfe mobile app saw lifetime-high registrations, while the recently launched Global Edge Savings account was received well. Other initiatives included the introduction of Video KYC and the deployment of data analytics, process automation and API-led architectures to improve operational efficiency.

"Our bank has opened 600-plus branches in the last three financial years, with an additional 116 branches in the current financial

PHOTO BY RAHUL RAUT